[METRIC]
AA-F-359H
December 5, 1991
SUPERSEDING
AA-F-359G
April 17, 1991

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FILING CABINETS, STEEL, LEGAL AND LETTER SIZE, VERTICAL

This specification is approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for use by all Federal Agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. The filing cabinets covered by this specification are contemporary style, heavy duty with satin finish, flush mounted drawer face hardware. The cabinets are compatible with other contemporary style, steel office furniture (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and sizes. The filing cabinets shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I. 2 drawers high, 1 drawer wide.
Type II. 3 drawers high, 1 drawer wide.
Type III. 4 drawers high, 1 drawer wide.
Type IV. 5 drawers high, 1 drawer wide.

Size 1. Legal size.
Size 2. Letter size.

Class A - With lock and locking mechanism.
Class B - Without lock.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government publications. The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-490 - Cleaning Methods for Ferrous Surfaces and Pretreatments for Organic Coatings

Federal Standards:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 595 - Colors.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO., Forth Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specification procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Iron and Steel Institute, Publication:

Steel Products Manual, Carbon Steel Sheets.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Iron and Steel Institute, 150 East 42nd Street, New York, NY 10017.)

National Motor Freight Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, D.C. 20036.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Uniform Classification Committee Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

American Society for Testing and Materials, Publications:

ASTM D-999 - Method for Vibration Testing of Shipping Containers
ASTM D-880 - Method for Incline Impact Test for Shipping Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First Article sample. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified in the contract. The contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies or services conform to prescribed requirements. Cabinets shall be inspected for the defects in table IV and for dimensional defects using the inspection levels and AQL's in 4.4.3.

3.2 Material. All materials shall be unused and free from defects which affect serviceability or appearance of the finished product.

3.2.1 Steel. The steel sheets used in the fabrication of the cabinets shall be commercial quality as defined in Steel Products Manual, cold rolled or cold rolled oiled, either of which shall have a stretcher leveled standard of flatness as defined in Steel Products Manual; hot rolled pickled and oiled; or hot rolled annealed. All steel shall be smooth, free from rust, scale, pits, scratches, laps and buckles affecting strength or appearance.

3.3 Face hardware. The exposed surfaces of all hardware shall be smooth and uniform and shall be free of sharp edges, burrs, pits, nicks, scratches, and blisters.

3.3.1 Face hardware for cabinets finished in any solid color.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The exposed surfaces of all face hardware used on a single unit shall be finished to match each other within the limits of the base material and protective plating used.

3.3.2 Locking mechanism for class A cabinets. All class A cabinets may be equipped with locks and an internal locking mechanism to control the locking of all cabinet drawers. The locking mechanism, when activated by the lock, shall hold the drawers positively locked and retained against any forward tilting of the file at any angle and against attempts to open locked drawers. The locking mechanism shall be designed and constructed so that any drawer or drawers left open can be closed and positively locked after the cabinet is locked, without unlocking the cabinet, and without damaging the locking mechanism. The locking mechanism and lock shall be securely installed in proper operating position to retain the lock and to provide ease in operating the lock and the internal locking mechanism.

3.3.3 Locks. The locking mechanism shall be activated by one key-operated lock. The lock shall be a disk or pin tumbler type, having not less than four disk or pin tumblers and shall be securely installed. The lock shall not be removable without the use of tools or manipulation of the lock bar. The lock shall have not less than 125 key changes. When in the locked position, the face of the installed lock shall project beyond the face of the cabinet case not less than 1.6 mm nor more than 4.8 mm. The face of the lock shall be die-cast zinc with a satin finish. The lock shall be lubricated with a lubricant recommended by the lock manufacturer. The lock shall be operated by a grooved key. Two identical keys shall be supplied with each lock. The keys shall operate easily and smoothly in performing their intended function.

3.4 Finishing materials.

3.4.1 Primer. The primer when used, shall be compatible with the finishing enamel.

3.4.2 Enamel. The enamel shall be of the baking type. The color shall be as specified by the contracting officer, from the list of colors in 3.4.4. The color of the enamel finish on the follower block and inner drawer fronts may be a different color than specified for the units, provided color harmony is maintained.

3.4.3 Plated Finish. The material used in the plating process shall be as normally used commercially to accomplish the quality specified.

3.4.4 Color of finish. Except as otherwise specified, the filing cabinets shall be finished in one of the following colors from Federal Standard No. 595:

Gray - No. 26134
Black - No. 27040

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

Parchment - No. 27769

(Sample panels of the above colors may be obtained from the Business Service Center, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D.C. 20407, or from the Business Service Center in the nearest General Services Administration Regional Office.)

3.5 Construction. The construction requirements specified herein are minimum. The contractor will exceed these requirements, wherever necessary to conform to the test provisions specified herein. Any detail not specified shall be consistent with quality production. All elements of construction shall be free of any conditions which hinder the proper function of any part of the units or which constitute a potential hazard to personnel or their clothing.

3.5.1 Brazing. When brazing is used instead of welding to join component parts, the brazing method shall include the use of nickel-bronze rod. When brazing is used as a filler, the brazing method may include the use of another rod having adequate tensile strength to assure that the brazed area will not crack or fracture under shipping, moving, or in-use conditions.

3.5.2 Dimensions. The overall, outside dimensions of the cabinet, exclusive of tolerances, shall be as specified in table I.

Tolerances:

Height — Type I and type II: Plus or minus 15 mm.
Type III and type IV: Plus or minus 25 mm.

Width — Plus or minus 15 mm.

Depth — Plus 13 mm, minus 2 mm (Exclusive of 3 mm maximum overhang of top).

TABLE I. Outside Overall Dimensions

Type	Size	Height	Width	Depth
I	legal size	743 mm	457 mm	711 mm
I	letter size	743 mm	381 mm	711 mm
II	legal size	1048 mm	457 mm	711 mm
II	letter size	1048 mm	381 mm	711 mm
III	legal size	1321 mm	457 mm	711 mm
III	letter size	1321 mm	381 mm	711 mm
IV	legal size	1502 mm	457 mm	711 mm
IV	letter size	1502 mm	381 mm	711 mm

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.3 Drawer dimensions. The clear filing capacity of the drawers shall be not less than the minimum inside drawer dimensions specified in table II. Inside drawer height shall be measured from the drawer inside bottom upward to the nearest obstruction above the filing material area. Inside depth shall be measured with the follower block in its most rearward position. The depth shall be the distance from the inside of the drawer front to the face of the follower block.

Table II. Minimum Inside Drawer Dimensions

Size	Height	Width	Depth
Size 1, legal size	260 mm	387 mm	648 mm
Size 2, letter size	260 mm	306 mm	648 mm

3.6 Assembly of cabinets. All welding and mechanical attachments shall accomplish secure and rigid joints in proper alignment. Welding and brazing shall be sound and without porosity and shall have sufficient strength to withstand the applicable tests; prohibit the loosening of any part; or cause any other defect which might affect the lifetime serviceability of the cabinet or drawers. All flanges which are to be welded to another piece shall be positioned to provide maximum welding area and strength and rigidity to the welded assembly.

3.6.1 Cabinet case. The cabinet case shall consist of front, top, sides, back and bottom. Bends or folds in addition to those specified are acceptable. The sides, top and back of the cabinet case shall have smooth even surfaces and shall be without holes or indentations except for scored knockouts. Knock-out outlines will be permitted in locking area in cabinet top on Class B cabinets.

3.7 Drawers. The drawer parts shall be constructed of quality steel. The inside height of the drawer side shall not be less than 127 mm or more than 178 mm. Drawer fronts may be flush with or may inset the vertical edges of the cabinet front not more than 3 mm. Each drawer shall be equipped with the face hardware specified in 3.7.3. They shall have full inner heads and spring activated follower blocks which engage slots or teeth or have a friction roller cam action, all of which are located in the middle or upper portion of the drawer sides. The follower block shall be adjustable the full depth of the drawer and shall engage solidly at stop points. The drawers shall be easily removable. The drawer assembly shall result in a drawer which is properly aligned. The drawer front shall fit squarely into the drawer opening equidistant on all sides.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.7.1 Drawer stops. Each drawer shall be provided with a stop which will prevent the drawer from hitting the back of the cabinet on the inward movement and with a positive stop which will prevent the drawer from falling out when fully extended. The stops encountered on the inward movement shall be equipped with bumpers of rubber or other comparable material.

3.7.2 Drawer suspensions, precision ball telescoping, steel. All drawer suspensions shall be a precision ball telescoping type. Movement shall be a smooth, even, telescoping action. Suspensions shall be lubricated with a lubricant recommended by the suspension manufacturer. All drawer suspensions shall withstand the applicable tests in section 4.

3.7.3 Drawer face hardware (pulls, latch releases, and label holders. The face hardware may be a single, recessed or pull type, integrated unit or may be separate units consisting of a drawer pull, latch release and label holder. The hardware unit shall be securely attached in the upper half of the outer drawer front. All surfaces of the hardware unit shall be finished and smooth to eliminate roughness and sharp edges.

3.7.4 Drawer pull. The pull part of the hardware shall be located below the label holder. It shall provide a comfortable hand grip, rounded and smooth to eliminate roughness and sharp edges. Pull may be with or without a thumb latch.

3.7.5 Drawer latch release mechanism. The latch release shall operate without jamming or binding.

3.7.6 Label holder. The label holder shall be located above and directly adjacent to the drawer pull. The label holder shall easily accept and firmly hold and retain without binding identification labels and cards.

3.7.6.1 Label holder outer frame. Stamped frames are not acceptable. The frame shall be complete on both sides, top, and bottom of the face hardware unit. The frame shall be mounted so as not to extend not more than 2 mm from the front face of the drawer. Screws or other retaining means shall not be visible.

3.9 Pretreatment and finishing.

3.9.1 Painted surfaces.

3.9.1.1 Pretreatment. All exterior and interior unplated ferrous metal surfaces, shall be treated for painting in accordance with any method of Federal Specification TT-C-490 or best commercial method.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.9.1.2 Priming. Unless type I or type II of TT-C-490 is used, all exterior and interior surfaces treated as specified in 3.9.1.1 shall be coated with primer specified in 3.4.1.

3.9.1.3 Painting. All pretreated surfaces shall be coated with the enamel or electrostatically applied powder base paint. File and storage drawer inner fronts, file drawer follower blocks, and storage drawer partitions may be a different color than specified for the units. The total dry film thickness on all exterior surfaces and on the top finish shall level out to produce smooth, uniform surfaces without runs, wrinkles, grits, areas of thin film or no film, and separation of color.

3.9.2 Plated finish.

3.9.2.1 Pretreatment. The components to be plated shall be cleaned and otherwise pretreated in a accordance with the standard commercial practice for the type of plating specified.

3.9.2.2 Chromium plating. The chromium plating shall not peel, chip or crack and it shall be free of uneven color, pits, blisters, stains, powder film and brush or grind marks.

3.9.3 Fastening hardware. The bolts, screws, nuts, and other fasteners shall be made to resist rust as commercially produced by the manufacturers of these items, unless specified herein. The use of paint or lacquer as the sole corrosion resistant agent is not acceptable

3.10 Identification label. There shall be an identification label affixed to the inside wall of the top drawer in the cabinet so as to be readily visible and readable when the drawer is open. It shall bear the contractor's name or trademark, contract or order number, item stock number, and year of manufacture.

3.11 Workmanship. A high degree of craftsmanship shall be exercised while performing the various operations of manufacture to eliminate the possibility of personal injury due to burrs and sharp edges; to assure that the occurrence of defects will not exceed the acceptable quality level specified herein; and to produce a finished commodity that is satisfactory in function, serviceability and appearance.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Inspection and testing responsibility. The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection and testing requirements in section 4. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

and tests set forth in the specification when they are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified, or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2 Lot acceptance tests. Lot acceptance tests shall be conducted under the supervision of the Government Inspector at the manufacturer's plant. In the event the manufacturer does not have the facilities to perform the required tests, he shall engage the services of a commercial testing laboratory acceptable to the Government. Copies of the laboratory report shall be submitted to the Government inspector upon receipt from the laboratory. All examination and testing shall be in accordance with Section 4 of this specification.

4.3 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.4 Inspection (end item).

4.4.1 Visual examination. Examination of the end item(s) shall be in accordance with the classification of defects specified in table IV and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) specified in 4.4.3. The lot size shall be expressed in the number of completed units for the purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit for this examination shall be one complete filing cabinet.

TABLE IV. Classification of Defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Painted finish 3.9.1.3 & 3.4.4	Indication of rust under coating.	X	
	Poor adhesion, tacky, color separation, stain, runs or foreign matter in coating.		X
	Wrong color.	X	
	Scratches or unpainted areas.	X	
	Abrasion or areas of thin coating.		X

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. Classification of Defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Workmanship 3.11	Any part missing, affecting appearance or serviceability.	X	
	Malformed, damaged, buckled, or warped parts affecting serviceability.	X	
	Sharp edges or projections that may cause injury.	X	
	Malformed, damaged, buckled, or warped parts affecting appearance.		X
Welding 3.5 & 3.6	Burnt through, cracked, fractured or not fused.	X	
	Flash or spatter on drawer interiors and exposed surfaces not removed.	X	
	Depressed or protruding spot welds on exterior surfaces not filled, sanded or ground smooth.		X
Locks 3.3.2	Wrong type.	X	
	After locking, drawers left open will not automatically engage locking mechanism.		X
Drawer pull 3.7	Not flush design specified.	X	
	Not secured as specified.		X
	Protrudes beyond the drawers front in excess allowable tolerance.	X	
	Rough or sharp edges that may cause injury.	X	
Label holder 3.7.6	Not located as specified.		X
	Does not securely retain index label.	X	
Latch mechanism	Does not hold drawer securely in closed position.		X

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. Classification of Defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Latch release 3.7.5	Does not operate easily and smoothly.		X
	Does not release latch mechanism.		X
Drawers 3.7 & 3.5.3	Drawer front does not fit square in opening.		X
	Not interior dimensions specified.	X	
Follower-block 3.7	Has rough or sharp edges.	X	
	Does not operate easily, quietly and smoothly.	X	
	Does not lock securely in right angle position.		X
Drawer suspension 3.7.2	Has rough or sharp edges affecting serviceability.	X	
	Suspension not rigidly secured to interior reinforcing members.	X	
	Ball bearings not as specified.	X	
Drawer stops 3.7.1	Stop does not prevent drawer from falling out.	X	
	Not equipped with bumpers or stops.	X	
Cabinet case 3.5.2	Not specified dimension.	X	
Bolts, nuts, screws and fastening devices 3.9.3	Not plated or finished as specified.		X
	Threads stripped.		X

4.4.2 Dimensional examination. Inspection will be made of cabinets for compliance with all dimensions specified. Unless otherwise specified any dimension not within tolerance specified shall be classified as a minor defect.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.3 Inspection levels and AQL'S. The acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed in defects per hundred units, and inspection levels shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, as follows:

	Inspection Levels	AQL's
For examination in Table I Major	ii	4.0
For examination in Table I Total	ii	10.0
For examination in 4.4.2 (1 class)	ii	4.0
For inspection in 4.5	s-2	4.0

4.5 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in Section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table V. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed in table V shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot.

TABLE V. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Packaging	Cabinet not cleaned.
	Drawer edges not cushioned.
	Top surfaces wadding sheet missing.
Packing	Corner posts not full height of cabinet.
	Top spring pad not folded to form 6-ply thickness.
Marking	Missing, illegible or not properly located.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.6 End item test. Sample cabinets shall be subjected to the tests specified in 4.7.1 through 4.7.8. Failure to withstand any one or more of the tests will provide reason to reject the First Article sample or samples selected by the Government inspector from the manufacturer's production of units under contract. Tests shall be repeated as specified in the contract or order or whenever a change is made in material, design, or method of production. Additional tests shall be performed at the discretion of the Government (see 4.1).

4.7 Preliminary examination prior to operational tests. Prior to the operational tests specified hereunder, all sample cabinets (First Article units and production units furnished under contract) shall be examined to determine compliance with workmanship and dimensional requirements. The sample shall then be examined to determine compliance with functional requirements, as follows:

The complete sample cabinet shall be placed in its normal upright position on a hard level surface. Except as otherwise specified herein, each drawer of the cabinet shall be loaded with the applicable weight specified below, which shall be equally distributed from front to back and side to side of the drawers in the following amounts. Equally distributed as used herein shall apply to front to back or laterally hung Pendaflex type folders loaded with steel shot weight or other typical filing material to the specified weight. Loaded weight does not include the weight of the drawer.

Size 1 -23 kg per drawer.
Size 2 - letter size - 23 kg per drawer.

Examination shall then be made of the operation of the drawers, the locking mechanism (if applicable), latching mechanism, follower blocks (with drawers loaded as specified above), and other moveable components. The drawer pull test specified in 4.7.1 shall then be performed. Failure to withstand drawer pull test or any other defect found by the Government inspector may provide reason to reject the sample. If the sample complies with requirements of the preliminary examination, it shall then be subjected to the operational tests specified in 4.7.1 through 4.7.8.

4.7.1 Drawer pull and push test. The drawer under test shall be loaded as specified in 4.7 and positioned as specified therein. The force to open and close the drawer shall be measured by an appropriate measuring gage. The operating force to open and close the drawer for the full distance of its travels shall not exceed 26.7 N for letter size drawer and shall not exceed 35.6 N for legal size drawers. These figures include overcoming the load imposed by an anti-rebound feature.

4.7.2 Suspension service test. The drawer selected for test

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

shall be loaded with the applicable weight specified in 4.7. The cabinet shall be securely anchored in its normal upright position on a solid, level floor surface. The suspension of the drawer to be tested shall be cleaned and lubricated or otherwise serviced by the manufacturer prior to the test and shall have no further service during the test period. The drawer shall be connected at the drawer pull location to a test machine which will operate the drawer out and in on the drawer suspension. The machine shall have a positive means (no springs) for adjusting the length of its stroke so that the drawer will travel its full distance (not more than 13 mm clearance at the end of each stroke).

The machine shall in no way contribute to the support of the drawer. The machine shall operate the drawer (out and in) at a rate of 15 cycle per minute (plus or minus 2 cycles) for 100,000 cycles. The drawer shall be subjected to the drawer pull-push test specified in 4.7.1 at each increment of 5,000 cycles. The drawer suspension shall be considered as having failed the suspension test if the force to operate the drawer at any time exceeds the forces specified in 4.7.1.

4.7.3 Rack test. Preliminary examination and test of the cabinet shall be made as specified in 4.7. The fully loaded cabinet shall then be raised not less than 25 mm from the floor surface and supported on square blocks at two diagonally opposite corners. The area of support shall be not more than 152 mm from each corner. The loaded cabinet shall remain in this position for 24 hours. After the 2 hour period, the distances from the support surface to The unsupported corners shall not more than 5 mmthee bottom of the unsupported corners shall be measured. The cabinet shall be returned to the level floor surfaces and examined and tested to determine compliance with all applicable requirements of this specification. The unsupported corners shall not have dropped more than 5 mm. Any resulting structural damage to the cabinet, or impairment of removable components, or failure to withstand the pull-push test in 4.7.1 shall provide cause to reject the cabinet

4.7.4 Static load test. Preliminary examination and test of the cabinet shall be made as specified in 4.7. The cabinet, loaded as specified therein, shall have the follower block in each drawer drawn up tight against the loaded material and then tipped backwards to an approximate 30 degree angle. The cabinet shall remain in this position and examined and tested to determine compliance with applicable specification requirements. Any resulting structural damage, impairment of moveable components, or failure to withstand the pull-push test in 4.7.1 shall provide reason to reject the cabinet. The test to be performed before 4.7.1.

4.7.5 Follower block test. A cabinet drawer with the follower block to be tested shall be loaded with the applicable weight specified below in the following amounts:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currenversion before use.

Size 1 - Legal size - 23 kg
Size 2 - Letter size - 16 kg

The loaded weight shall be held against the inside front of the drawer by the follower block and shall be drawn tight against the drawer front and then released approximately one inch. The location of the follower block shall then be marked on the bottom of the drawer. The test machine specified in 4.7.2 shall be connected to the drawer as specified therein. The test machine shall operate the drawer (out and in) for 500 cycles at the rate specified in 4.7.2. Upon conclusion of 500 cycles, the location of the follower block shall be indicated by a second mark on the bottom of the drawer. As a result of this test, the movement of the follower block, as indicated by the two marks, shall be not more than 7 mm. There shall be no loosening or damage to the follower block or its support and no displacement of the load.

4.7.6 Forward and backward impact test for latch-closed devices. All drawers of the cabinet shall be loaded with the applicable load specified in 4.7. All drawer shall be closed and locked. They shall be retained on a level concrete, tile, or equivalent solid floor surface. The cabinet shall then be tilted backwards along the back bottom edge of the cabinet. The tilt angle shall be to just before the balance point of the tilt so that, when released, it will fall forward, back-to-front. The cabinet shall then be allowed to free-fall forward under its own weight to impact. To complete the test cycle, the cabinet shall be tilted forward at the angle specified above so as to rest evenly along the front bottom edge of the cabinet. The cabinet shall then be allowed to free-fall backward to impact. The above back-to-front and front-to-back impact cycle shall be repeated 5 times. Upon conclusion of the 5 cycle test all cabinet drawers shall have remained closed throughout the tests, and there shall have been no failed rivets, welds, pins, or catches; and all drawers shall withstand the drawer pull-push test in 4.7.1.

4.7.7 Cabinet frame side racking test. All cabinet drawers shall be loaded with the applicable load specified in 4.7. The cabinet shall be placed on a level floor surface and restrained from side skid movement by a 100 mm high stop or barrier placed flush against the side of the cabinet secured to the floor surface. All drawers shall be opened 200 mm to 250 mm from their closed position. A static load of 16 kg shall then be applied to the cabinet, outward normal to the plane of the file side (see figure 1). The cabinet shall be subjected to the static load for 30 minutes. The cabinet shall not tip over with the 16 kg load applied. At the conclusion of the 30 minute test period, with the 16 kg load still applied, there shall be no deflection in the cabinet or drawer sufficient to prevent any of the drawers from being fully closed by hand. The cabinet frame shall not be manipulated to assist closing the drawers. The drawers shall be examined and closed from top drawer down to the bottom drawer. The static load shall then be removed, the cabinet leveled, and

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

all drawers subjected to the drawer operating test in 4.7.1. Failure of any of the drawers to close when the cabinet is in the tipped position (after the 30 minute load period) and failure of any of the drawers to comply with the drawer operating test specified in 4.7.1 after the cabinet has been returned to the upright position and leveled, shall be cause to reject the cabinet. Failure of the cabinet to withstand the 16 kg test load without tipping over is also cause for rejection.

4.7.8 Drawer lock test. Class A cabinet (with lock) shall be tested as follows. All drawers of the cabinet shall be loaded as specified in 4.7. The cabinet drawer latch mechanism shall be deactivated and the file shall be locked. The file shall be tipped forward at an angle of not less than 30 degrees. It shall then be returned to the upright position. Any drawers opening while the file is being tipped, while it is in the tipped position, or while it is being returned to the upright position shall be cause for rejection. If the file complies with the above first part of the test, an attempt shall be made to open each drawer by hand. There shall be three attempts to open each drawer. The pull shall be (1) straight outward, (2) upward at an angle of approximately 45 degrees, and (3) outward type motion, and shall equal to a force of not less than 14 kg. If any drawer opens during the performance of this pull test, it shall be cause for rejection.

4.7.9 Shipping shock test. The test equipment shall comply with ASTM D-880. A complete fully assembled unit (cartoned) shall be submitted for test. Prior to cartoning, the unit shall be inspected for visual or functional damage and documented. The cartoned unit shall be placed onto the impact machine dolly flush against the back stop and parallel to the leading edge of the dolly. The catch mechanism located on the side of the dolly shall be tripped to allow the dolly to move up the incline at a 10 0 angle. Once the dolly hits the automatic trip mechanism, the dolly will freely roll down the incline at a distance of four feet and impact the back stop. This procedure shall be performed on the remaining 5 sides of the cabinet. The carton shall have failed the test if there is visual, structural or functional damage to the unit.

4.7.10 Shipping vibration test. The test equipment shall comply with ASTM D-999. 1) A complete fully assembled unit shall be submitted for test. Prior to cartoning the unit, shall be an inspection for visual and functional damage. The packaged product shall be placed on the vibration platform in its normal shipping position. Set the vibration frequency at a minimum speed sufficient to cause the packaged product to leave the platform momentarily so that a 2 mm shim may be inserted at least 100 mm between the packaged product and the surface of the platform. vibrate the packaged product for a total of one hour. A single 90° horizontal rotation should be accomplished after the first one half hour of vibration, (if the size of the product makes a 90°

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-02-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

rotation impractical, a 180° horizontal rotation is permissible.) 2) Place the packaged product on the platform in its normal shipping position. Using the same vibration frequency, vibrate the packaged product for one half hour on each of its six sides, (three hours total). Inspect the carton for visual, structural or functional damage. Remove the product from the carton and inspect it for visual, structural or functional damage to the unit.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A and B. Each cabinet shall be wiped clean with a soft, nonabrasive cleaning cloth just prior to packaging. A cleaning agent that will not harm the finish shall be used as required. The follower blocks or other internal parts that may come loose in handling and shipment shall be secured in place with tape, fiberboard forms, or by other suitable means. The top surface of each cabinet shall be protected with a sheet of cellulose wadding or other nonabrasive cushioning material, minimum thickness 3 mm. The sheet shall be held in place by closing the top drawer on the portion extending down the front and by taping the remaining three sides in place. The top edge of each remaining drawer front shall be protected with a strip of cellulose wadding not less than 3 mm thick or with 51 mm x 51 mm x 3.2 mm thick pads of fiber felt or polyurethane foam placed over the two top corners. When locks are provided, the drawers shall be closed, the unit locked, the keys placed in a cotton drawstring bag, or a bag made of polyethylene film not less than 0.05 mm thick, and the bag secured in a recessed drawer handle.

5.1.2 Level C. Each cabinet shall be wiped clean as specified in 5.1.1, and then prepared for packing to insure adequate protection against abrasion and damage during shipment.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, and C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A or B. Fiberboard "L" shaped corner posts extending the full height of the cabinet shall be used in all four corners of the pack. The fiberboard forming the corner posts shall be slit-scored and folded face width of 64 mm. A fiberboard spring pad extending the full inside length and width dimensions of the box shall be positioned on the top and bottom of each unit. The fiberboard forming the spring pad shall be slit-scored and folded. The slit-scored folds shall be parallel the length of the box.

5.2.2 Level C. Cabinets prepared as specified in 5.1.2 shall be individually packed in boxes that will assure acceptance and safe delivery in compliance with National Motor Freight or Uniform Freight Classification Rules. Packed units shall be

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

tested in accordance with paragraphs 4.7.9 and 4.7.10.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. Each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.3 Special Marking. In addition to the marking required by 5.3.1 or 5.3.2, each shipping container shall be marked as follows:

(a) On a side panel:
UP
FURNITURE
FRAGILE, HANDLE WITH CARE

(b) In an upper corner of both end panels, a standard UP arrow.

(c) On a top panel:
TOP
THIS SIDE UP

(d) One side panel shall be marked with the appropriate package certificate, "60-F".

(e) To facilitate color identification, the side and one end panel of each shipping container shall have an area approximately 76 mm x 152 mm painted to match the color of the cabinet packed. Alternatively, adhesive backed color panels of the size specified above shall be applied to the container.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The filing cabinets are intended for heavy duty use in storing heavy, correspondence type, filing material. The 2-drawer files are intended for desk-side use when frequent reference is necessary. The 3-drawer files are intended primarily for built-in counter use or where space height will not accommodate 5-drawer files. The 4-drawer files are intended for use only when it has been determined that 5-drawer files cannot be used. The 5-drawer files provide the most advantageous filing equipment from the standpoint of economy, space utilization and efficient records management.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(b) Type, style, and class required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Whether First Article sample is required (see 3.1*).
(d) Color of baking enamel to be applied (see 3.2.4*).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Selection of applicable levels of marking (see 5.3).
(g) Frequency of quality assurance testing (see 4.6.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.